

Travel and Expense Policy

Northwind Labs · Finance · Effective 1 March 2099

This policy defines which business expenses Northwind reimburses, the limits that apply, and who must approve them. It applies to all employees and contractors who incur expenses on the company's behalf, including remote employees claiming a home-office stipend.

1. General Principles

- Spend the company's money as if it were your own: choose the reasonable option.
- Keep an itemized receipt for every expense; a card statement line is not a receipt.
- Submit expenses within 30 days of incurring them so the books close cleanly.
- Personal, entertainment-only, and out-of-policy expenses are not reimbursed.

2. Approval Authority

Approval scales with the amount. Smaller expenses are auto-approved once a receipt is attached; larger amounts route to your manager and then to Finance.

Amount	Approver	Pre-approval
Up to \$100	Auto-approved with receipt	Not required
\$100 - \$1,000	Direct manager	Required before purchase
\$1,000 - \$5,000	Manager + Finance	Required before purchase
Over \$5,000	Department head + Finance	Required, with justification

3. Travel

Book travel through the company tool when possible. Economy airfare is the standard; premium cabins need department-head approval. Lodging should be a standard business room near the work location. Meals on travel days are covered by a per-diem rather than itemized receipts.

Region	Per-diem (meals)	Lodging cap / night
Domestic, standard city	\$65	\$220
Domestic, high-cost city	\$80	\$320
International	\$90	\$300

4. Home Office and Equipment

Remote employees may claim a one-time home-office setup stipend of up to \$750 for a desk, chair, monitor, and peripherals, with manager approval. Ongoing internet costs are not separately reimbursed. Company laptops are provided by IT and are not part of the stipend. Equipment over the stipend follows the approval table above.

5. Meals and Entertainment

On non-travel days, team meals and client meals are reimbursable within reason and with a clear business purpose recorded on the receipt. Alcohol is reimbursable only as a modest part of a client meal, never as a standalone expense. Recurring individual meals and groceries are personal and are not reimbursed.

Occasion	Limit per person	Approval
Team meal (in office)	\$30	Auto with receipt
Client meal	\$80	Manager
Offsite / team event	\$120	Manager + Finance

6. Corporate Cards and Personal Funds

Employees who incur frequent expenses may be issued a corporate card; charges still require receipts and follow the same approval table. If you pay out of pocket, you are reimbursed on the next payroll run after approval. Cash advances are not provided; use the corporate card or seek pre-approval for large planned costs.

7. Non-Reimbursable Expenses

- Traffic fines, parking tickets, and late fees of any kind.
- Personal entertainment, in-room movies, and minibar charges.
- Travel upgrades or premium cabins without department-head approval.
- Home internet and personal phone plans (covered by the home-office stipend rules).

8. Submitting Expenses

Enter expenses in the expense tool, attach itemized receipts, and tag the category. Approved reimbursements are paid with the next payroll run, typically within ten business days of approval. A rejected expense comes back with a reason; correct it and resubmit. Questions about a category or a limit go to Finance through the #finance channel before you spend, not after.